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Document Owner: National Head of Transition & Transformation (T&T)

Service Transition From Incumbent Vendor Guide: VI Business (India)

1. Executive Purpose and Document Scope

The Service Transition From Incumbent Vendor Guide defines the precise, multi-phased methodology VI Business (India) employs when wresting control of an enterprise network or security architecture away from a hostile or uncooperative legacy competitor.

This artifact proves to the enterprise CIO that we possess a battle-tested blueprint for mitigating the severe operational risks inherent in displacing an incumbent vendor, particularly regarding undocumented legacy configurations and "Hostage" scenarios where the incumbent refuses to release SIP numbers or routing tables.

2. Definitions, Assumptions, and Applicability

Definitions:

- **T&T:** Transition and Transformation.
- **Incumbent:** The legacy telecom/managed services provider currently operating the customer's network.
- **As-Is:** The current state of the architecture.
- **To-Be:** The future state operating on VI Business infrastructure.
- **Parallel Run:** Running both the legacy and the new VI networks simultaneously.

Assumptions:

- Incumbent vendors rarely cooperate fully; transition timelines inherently account for a 20% delay buffer due to legacy vendor resistance.
- The Customer holds the ultimate legal leverage to compel the incumbent’s cooperation.

Applicability:

- **Target Audience:** Bid Writers, Transition Managers, Enterprise Project Management Office (PMO).
- **Scope:** Large-scale WAN migrations, SOC platform replacements (e.g., migrating from legacy ArcSight to VI Splunk), and massive SIP Trunk MNP (Mobile Number Portability) migrations.

3. Phase 1: Transition Discovery and Documentation

Knowledge transfer cannot rely on the incumbent providing accurate diagrams (which are historically outdated or intentionally withheld).

- **Automated Discovery:** VI Business deploys non-intrusive scanning appliances (e.g., SolarWinds Network Configuration Manager) onto the customer LAN to automatically crawl and map the *actual* active BGP/OSPF topologies, completely bypassing the incumbent's documentation.
- **Asset and Configuration Capture:** All discovered hardware (routers, switches, firewalls) and their exact firmware versions, active interfaces, and VLAN tags are documented in the central ServiceNow Configuration Management Database (CMDB) under the "As-Is" state.

4. Phase 2: Knowledge Transfer & Gap Analysis

- **Incumbent Workshops:** The VI T&T team requests a maximum of two (2) joint workshops with the Customer and the Incumbent to discuss undocumented bespoke routing (e.g., static routes to obscure legacy ERP servers).
- **Gap Analysis:** If the incumbent refuses to attend, VI Business forces a "Black Box" reverse-engineering phase, deploying packet sniffers to analyze the source/destination matrix of the legacy traffic and reconstructing the QoS (Quality of Service) policy from observing actual packet flows.

5. Phase 3: The Parallel Run and Co-existence

To ensure zero downtime during a 12-month, 5,000-site migration, neither network can exist in isolation.

- **Network-to-Network Interface (NNI):** A high-capacity optical fiber (e.g., 10 Gbps) is provisioned physically connecting the VI Business Tier-III Core directly into the Incumbent's legacy Data Center.
- **Routing Logic:** This NNI acts as a bridge. A site migrated to VI SD-WAN on Tuesday can seamlessly communicate across the NNI with a legacy site that isn't scheduled for migration until November.
- **Validation:** The Parallel Run phase proves routing stability *before* the first edge branch is physically cut over.

6. Phase 4: Cutover Ownership and Execution

The physical migration (the "Cutover") is executed site-by-site during approved maintenance windows (See: *Migration and Cutover Playbook VIB-DEL-MIG-017*).

- **Absolute Authority:** During the Cutover Window (e.g., Saturday 23:00 IST), the VI Transition Manager assumes absolute dictatorial control over the bridge. No changes are executed by the incumbent or the customer without the VI Commander's explicit verbal authorization.

7. Phase 5: Exit Coordination and Decommissioning

Once the final remote branch is successfully migrated and stabilized across a 14-day Hypercare period, the legacy network is cleanly amputated.

- **Tearing Down the NNI:** The BGP peering across the coexistence NNI is administratively shut down. The VI network now operates entirely independently.
- **Asset Recovery coordination:** VI Business does not decommission or physically remove the incumbent's hardware. The Customer IT team is responsible for packing and returning the legacy vendor's appliances to avoid liability claims regarding damaged property.

8. Specific Risk Controls (The "Hostage" Scenarios)

Customers frequently ask how we manage hostile incumbents.

1. **Risk: Refusal to release Number Portability (SIP/PRI):**

    - *Control:* VI Business Regulatory & Legal teams escalate directly to the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) ombudsman, utilizing strict MNP/FLNP (Fixed Line Number Portability) mandates to force the incumbent compliance within 7 days.
2. **Risk: Withholding Admin Passwords:**
    - *Control:* Completely bypassed by the NNI coexistence model. We simply route around the legacy edge hardware, rendering their admin access irrelevant to the new To-Be topology.

9. Constraints, Exclusions, and Dependency Notes

- **Legal Disclaimers:** VI Business cannot assume legal liability for early-termination penalties (ETC) levied by the incumbent vendor against the customer. The customer retains all financial responsibility for severing their legacy contracts.

10. Proposal-Use Guidance

- **Answering "Transition Plan" RFPs:** Directly extract Section 3 (Automated Discovery) and Section 8 (Risk Controls). Enterprise buyers are terrified of vendor lock-in; proving that VI Business possesses the specialized engineering methodology to forcibly extract them from a hostile legacy provider is a massive competitive differentiator.

11. Governance and Ownership

- **Owner:** National Head of Transition & Transformation (T&T)
- **Reviewers:** Head of Enterprise Legal, Solution Engineering TDA (Technical Design Authority).
- **Update Cadence:** Annual, verified by lessons-learned data derived from Post-Implementation Reviews (PIRs) of major migrations.